

# KENTARO NAKAMURA

Contact: knakamura [at] g.harvard.edu

Website: <https://k-nakam.github.io>

## EDUCATION

---

### Harvard University

Ph.D. | *Public Policy* (Politics and Institution Track)

- Affiliation: Institute of Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)

Sep.2023 – Present

Cambridge, USA

### University of Chicago

Master of Science | *Statistics*

Sep.2021 – Jun.2023

Chicago, USA

### Waseda University

Bachelor of Arts | *Major: Political Science, Minor: Law, Certificate: Data Science*

- Best Paper Award (Excellent work at the Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)

Apr.2017 – Sep.2021

Tokyo, Japan

### George Washington University

Exchange Program

Aug.2019 – May.2020

Washington D.C., USA

## RESEARCH INTEREST

---

Causal Inference with Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Political Communication, Political Violence

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

---

### Understanding the Impact of Military Service on Support for Insurrection in the United States

*Journal of Conflict Resolution*, with Robert Pape, Keven Ruby, and Kyle Larson [\[URL\]](#)

- analyzed why and how civilians with prior military experiences are prone to support political violence.

### Balancing Opportunities and Incentives: How Rising China's Mediated Public Diplomacy Changes under Crisis

*International Journal of Communication* [\[URL\]](#)

- estimated the strategic shift of the rising China's public diplomacy under crisis by machine learning

## SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

---

### Causal Representation Learning with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments

*Revise and Resubmit*, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- developed new experimental designs to use texts created by deep generative model as a treatment

### Gen-AI Powered Inference

*Under Review*, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- proposed a new framework to use the internal representations of deep generative models for statistical inference

### Surrogate Representation Inference for Text and Image Annotations

*Under Review* [\[URL\]](#)

- proposed a framework to improve efficiency with noisy and partially observed annotations
- Best poster award at the 2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology.

## SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

---

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2025). "Surrogate Representation Inference for Noisy Text and Image Annotations", *Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2025). "Gen-AI Powered Inference", *2025 Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2025, Poster). "Efficient Statistical Inference from Partial and Noisy Annotations: Application to Text-as-Outcome", *2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology*

Kosuke Imai, **Kentaro Nakamura** (2025). "Gen-AI Powered Inference", *2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2025). "Causal Representation Learning with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments", *Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University*

Kosuke Imai, **Kentaro Nakamura** (2025). "Causal Representation Learning with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments", *Japanese Society for Quantitative Political Science 2025 Winter Meeting*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2024, Poster). "Causal Inference with Unstructured High-Dimensional Treatments using Deep Generative Models: Applications to Images and Texts", *2024 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2023). "Improving Text as Treatment Framework", *Japanese Society for Quantitative Political Science 2023 Summer Meeting*

**Kentaro Nakamura**, Yuki Mikiya (2023). "International Credibility for Domestic Legitimacy? How Authoritarian Country Coordinated its Narratives during the Crisis", *Southern Political Science Association*

**Kentaro Nakamura** (2022). "How Rising Powers' Public Diplomacy Changes under Difficulties: the case of China", *Japanese Society for Quantitative Political Science 2022 Winter Meeting*

## SOFTWARE

---

### Debriefly

Survey Software for Automated Cognitive Debriefing (Available upon Requests)

### gpi-pack [\[URL\]](#)

Python module for Generative-AI Powered Inference.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

---

|                                               |                    |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Research Assistant for Prof. Gary King</b> | May.2024 – Present |
| Harvard University                            | Cambridge, USA     |

- worked as coauthor on automated cognitive debriefing project

|                                                  |                    |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Research Assistant for Prof. Matthew Baum</b> | Nov.2023 – Present |
| Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School       | Cambridge, USA     |

|                                                                         |                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Data and Causal Inference Analyst</b>                                | Sep.2022 – Aug.2023 |
| Chicago Projects on Security and Threats (CPOST), University of Chicago | Chicago, USA        |

- designed experiments, discussed identification strategies, and implemented causal mediation analysis

|                                                     |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Research Assistant for Prof. Shuhei Kurizaki</b> | May.2020 – Sep.2021 |
| Waseda University                                   | Tokyo, Japan        |

- conducted qualitative research on the foreign takeover in Europe (Co-Author since September 2020)

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

---

|                                                                                      |                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Statistical Models for Quantitative Social Science)</b> | Spring 2026    |
| Harvard University                                                                   | Cambridge, USA |

- offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

|                                                                      |                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Teaching Fellow: GOV2002 (Causal Inference with Applications)</b> | Fall 2025      |
| Harvard University                                                   | Cambridge, USA |

- offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

|                                                          |                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Teaching Assistant at the Center for Data Science</b> | Sep.2020 – Mar.2021 |
| Waseda University                                        | Tokyo, Japan        |

- checked class materials and answered the questions about Statistics and Machine Learning

## HONORS AND AWARDS

---

|                                                                                                                                                                                           |                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Society of Political Methodology Best Poster Award</b><br>Best Method Poster presented by graduate students at PolMeth2025 (Emory) <a href="#">[News]</a>                              | Jul.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant</b><br>Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD2,000)                                                         | Apr.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant</b><br>Research Grant for the joint project with Jing Ling Tan and George Yang (USD2,000)                          | Apr.2025              |
| <b>Harvard Kennedy School Travel Grant</b><br>Travel Grant for attending JSQPS2025 Winter Meeting (USD1000)                                                                               | Jan.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Travel Grant</b><br>Travel Grant for attending PolMeth2024 (USD500)                                                               | Jul.2024              |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Merit-based scholarship. Partial tuition coverage (JPY 3 million yen) and monthly stipends.                                   | Sep.2023 - Aug.2026   |
| <b>Graduate Council Research &amp; Personal Development Fund, University of Chicago</b><br>Travel Grant for attending SPSA2023 (USD600)                                                   | Jan. 2023             |
| <b>Tuition Fellowship, University of Chicago</b><br>Equivalent to 25 percent of my approved tuition. Increased to 30% from 2nd year                                                       | Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023 |
| <b>Statistics Consulting Cup Awards</b><br>Best Prize in the Consulting Program at the Department of Statistics. <a href="#">[News]</a>                                                   | Dec.2021              |
| <b>NSK Ltd. Scholarship</b><br>Scholarship provided only for top four students in Japan. JPY13,600,000 $\approx$ USD100,000                                                               | Sep.2021 – Jun.2023   |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Declined to accept NSK Scholarship. Merit-based scholarship.                                                                  | Mar.2021              |
| <b>Best Paper Award (Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)</b><br>Thesis Competition of the Waseda Association for Political Science and Economics <a href="#">[News]</a> | Feb.2021              |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Merit based scholarship to support exchange program. JPY900,000. $\approx$ USD7,000                                           | Aug.2019 – May.2020   |

## ACADEMIC SERVICES / DISCUSSANT ROLES

---

**Discussant:** SPSA (2023), APSA (2025)  
**Reviewer:** Political Analysis (2), International Studies Quarterly  
**Others:** Coordinator of Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2025-2026)

## SKILLS

---

**Languages:** Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (B1; Intermediate)  
**Programming:** (Proficient) Python(3.X), R, C++ (Rcpp),  $\LaTeX$ , ArcGIS, STATA, HTML / (Experience) C, SQL

## REFERENCES

---

Available upon request

*Last updated on March 2, 2026*